Decisions: if and else

Programming · Level 2 · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Compare with == and the other operators.
- Write if, elif and else with colons and indents.
- Join conditions with and and or.

Key ideas

- = stores; == compares.
- Only the first true branch runs.
- Test at the boundary: 11, 12, 13.

Activity: The human ticket machine

1. Warm-up (3 min): Write the ticket rule as if, elif and else.
2. Play (7 min): One of you is the machine; others give ages.
3. Test (7 min): Make a table of boundary ages.
4. Check (3 min): Run the program with your table.

The machine follows only the rule on paper, not common sense. That is exactly how a computer works.

Let's discuss

1. Why is 12 the age most likely to go wrong?
2. When would you use and, and when or?
3. Why does Python need two = signs to compare?

Exit ticket

- Write an if line that is True only for ages 13 to 19.